

Honey bees

Bees swarm when they leave their hive to find a new home. Once a small number of special "scouts" have agreed on the most suitable site, the queen and the main cluster of bees fly to the new location.



Monarch migration

Every year, by instinct alone, millions of monarch butterflies travel up to 2,500 miles (4,000 km) from northern parts of America to warmer climates as far south as Mexico, before they return north in spring.



Midges

Huge swarms appear over Lake Victoria in Africa during the annual mating season, as thousands of dancing male midges try to attract females. Swarms are so big, they look like giant brown clouds.



Froghopper

Highest jumper. Jumps 28 in (71 cm)—150 times its own height, which is comparable to a human jumping over a 60-story building!



Himalayan cicada

Loudest. Calls at up to 120 decibels—as loud as an ambulance siren.



Stink bug

Smelliest. Toxic odor can be smelled by humans about 3.3–5 ft (1–1.5 m) away.



Flea

Longest jumper. Can jump more than 200 times its body length.



SCIENTISTS ESTIMATE
4–20 MILLION
TYPES OF INSECTS HAVE
YET TO BE DISCOVERED

Chan's megastick

Longest. 22.3 in (56.7 cm). Only six specimens have ever been found, all on the island of Borneo.

Australian tiger beetle

Fastest runner. 5.6 mph (9 kph). Equivalent to a human running at 480 mph (770 kph).

Dung beetle

Strongest. Can pull 1,141 times its own body weight—the equivalent to an average human pulling six double-decker buses full of people.



Giant weta

Heaviest. Weighs up to 2.5 oz (70 g)—heavier than a sparrow.



Horsefly

Fastest flyer. Maximum speed recorded briefly on takeoff at 90 mph (145 kph). The next fastest are dragonflies and hawk moths, at about 30–35 mph (50–55 kph).



Insects

We know of more than 1 million different types of insects, and more are identified every year. They have fascinating habits, and their strange appearances can be seen with the help of microscopes and special cameras.